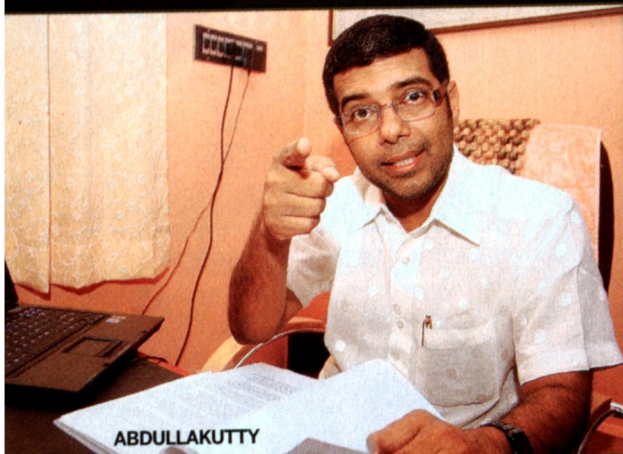


ABDULLAKUTTY'S PRAISE OF NARENDRA MODI HAS LEFT THE CPI(M) FUMING.



ABDULLAKUTTY

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM | Red Marks

Coming from one of its own comrades, it was blasphemy when A.P. Abdullakkutty, CPI(M) MP from Kannur, praised Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi. "Modi is the best example of development policy. People of Gujarat elect him repeatedly because of his commitment to the state's development," Abdullakkutty said in Dubai. The wrath of his comrades now rains down on him. "Only fools can praise Modi who is an enemy of humanity," said E.P. Jayarajan, CPI(M) member of Parliament. The unrepentant Abdullakkutty says he praised only Modi's development policies, not the man and his politics. Modi was only too happy to be the centre of this new Marxist debate, saying, "Thorough communists too have started respecting our policies."

by M.G. Radhakrishnan

IN A BID TO SAVE BHOPAL'S HISTORIC LAKE, CHOUHAN PROMISES TO WORK ON THE SITE FOR AN HOUR EVERY SUNDAY.

CHOUHAN GIVES THE LAKE A HELPING HAND

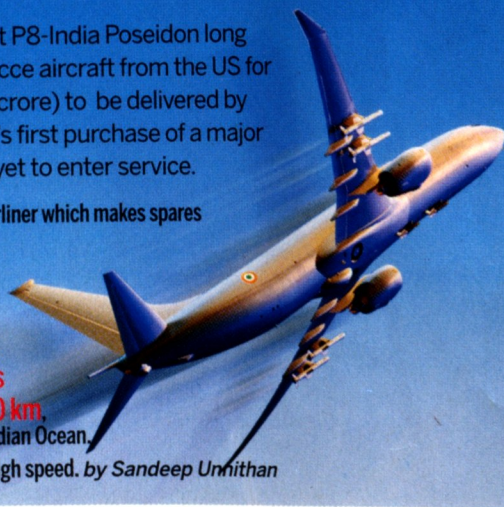


PANKAJ TIWARI

DELHI | Long Ranger BOEING P8-I

India will buy eight P8-India Poseidon long range maritime recce aircraft from the US for \$2 bn (Rs 10,000 crore) to be delivered by 2012. This is India's first purchase of a major weapons system yet to enter service.

- Based on the 737 airliner which makes spares and support easy
- Carries sonar buoys and torpedoes to hunt submarines
- Anti-ship missiles to hunt enemy warships
- With range of 2,200 km, can cover the entire Indian Ocean.
- Jet powered for high speed. by Sandeep Unnithan



DELHI | Virus Can

It was called W32Autorun and attacked Indian computers more than any other virus in 2008. IT security firm Quick Heal Technologies has estimated that 2,60,000 instances of the virus were recorded in India, and another 3,50,000 more worldwide. It had a total of 1,000 variants in 2008 and 200-300 variants in a month. The virus sneaked into data storage systems, eating up the system's resources and adding its code to running applications. by Nandini Valsh

BHOPAL | Son of the Soil

Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan has a penchant for making populist gestures like riding a bicycle to his office when oil prices had peaked last year. This time round he sweated it out for an hour excavating soil from the dry bed of the 1,000-year-old Upper Lake in Bhopal. Large portions of the lake had dried out due to poor rainfall. The lake is the lifeline of the Madhya Pradesh capital, meeting almost half of its water requirement. Chouhan will work at the lake for an hour every Sunday and will donate a month's salary as his contribution to the cause to save the lake.

by Ambresh Mishra